



PROGRESS REPORT

South Sudan: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 72 systems and instruments tracked

Of 72 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 40 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 15 did not, 5 carry no stated baseline, and 12 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 89 sources for this place in the window — 29 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 60 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The payments layer gained wholesale plumbing and no retail rail. [SSIPS went live on 10 October 2025 with 13 banks](#), combining real-time gross settlement and automated clearing; the retail instant system [announced with AfricaNenda in February 2025 passed its December 2025 rollout target with no go-live documented](#). Over the same period cash was removed as a payment channel for [passports](#) and then for [tax at revenue offices](#).

Identity moved in supply rather than in system. [Passport issuance recovered from a shortage across every category to about three days' processing](#) and [five production machines were delivered](#), while birth registration stood at [about 10% at both ends of the period](#).

The governance layer arrived in the wrong order. A [cybercrime statute entered force in February 2026](#) while the [data-protection bill went from no draft to a drafted policy bill and no further](#). One position worsened: the [cost of mobile data was raised twice with no rate published](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Full-digitisation decree (Electronic Services Council)	Did not exist	In force; the January 2026 deadline passed with no compliance report published (2026-08)	ADVANCED, DEADLINE PASSED WITHOUT A COMPLIANCE REPORT
National e-commerce strategy	None published (2025-08)	None published, unchanged from the November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target (2026-06)	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act 2026	Did not exist	In force; the full text was withheld from journalists at signing (2026-02)	ADVANCED
ICT Authority	Did not exist	Being established as a state entity under the ICT ministry while legislation is awaited (2026-08)	ADVANCED
South Sudan Official Gazette	Not operating; no law, decree or resolution published since 2011 (2025-08)	A technical committee ordered to operationalise the physical and electronic editions with encrypted digital verification, read-only public access on a redesigned presidential website, and clearance of the publication backlog since 2011; no maiden edition is on file (2026-08)	ADVANCED, NO EDITION PUBLISHED
National Payment System Bill, 2025	Not held	Validated at a five-day workshop opened on 10 August 2026 by the central bank and parliament, backed by the East African Community secretariat and the Bank of Uganda, covering mobile money, electronic money, payment switches and real-time gross settlement with licensing, consumer-protection and systemic-risk provisions; on 17 August the central bank governor called for faster progress toward passage	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Bill	No draft on record	Policy bill drafted with civil-society facilitation; no bill before the Assembly and no statute (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Kenya-South Sudan cross-border digital connectivity memorandum	Did not exist	Signed as the regional project's first cross-border connectivity memorandum and offered as the template for the remaining bilaterals; no text, capacity or tariff terms published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
African Telecommunications Union collaboration	Not held	Deeper collaboration on infrastructure, capacity building and standardisation pledged at the minister's visit to the union's Nairobi headquarters on 12 August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

Four instruments moved and each moved less far than its announcement suggests. The [Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act](#) went from not existing to in force in February 2026, with its full text withheld at signing. The [data-protection bill](#) went from no draft to a drafted policy bill and is not before the Assembly, so the country ended the period as it began it, with constitutional privacy and no statute.

The [full-digitisation decree](#) entered force in December 2025 with a January 2026 deadline for all public institutions to adopt digital systems; the deadline passed inside the period and no compliance report has been published. The [ICT Authority](#) went from not existing to being established while legislation is awaited, on an account that does not sit with the [May 2026 report](#) that its legal framework was signed.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Air Traffic Management System loan (China Eximbank)	Committed	Committed; no implementation record held	NO CHANGE

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project	Under implementation, rated Moderately Unsatisfactory on the development objective and Unsatisfactory on implementation, overall risk High (2025-08)	US\$162m of IDA after a US\$10m partial cancellation in Somalia in April 2026; development objective raised to Moderately Satisfactory and implementation to Moderately Unsatisfactory, overall risk lowered to Substantial, with fiduciary and environmental and social risk both staying High (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Private-sector investment mobilised under the regional digital project	US\$0 against a US\$20m target for South Sudan	US\$0 against a US\$20m target for South Sudan (2026-06)	NO CHANGE

External financing commitments were unchanged over the period: the [Chinese education technical cooperation](#) commitment and the [air traffic management loan](#) both stood as committed at start and end, with no implementation record entering the base.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bayobab national and cross-border fibre network	No licensed national backbone operator	15-year licence effective 16 October 2025; build in execution linking the eastern and western corridors through Juba (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Mobile coverage extension in Kauto Administrative Area	One site, at Kuron	One site, at Kuron; four further sites requested and an expected February 2026 extension not delivered (2026-07)	STALLED
National fibre backbone programme (2,400 km via Kenya)	US\$9m design budget approved, no route announced (2025-06)	2,400 km route announced and fibre tendering stated to start in the second half of 2026; no construction start or completion date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy	Did not exist	Development launched; no strategy, band plan, auction design or timetable published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Telecommunications tariff exchange-rate adjustment	Did not exist	Three operators raised voice and data prices on 17 August 2026 following an earlier June increase, and the legislature has challenged the repeated rises and moved to summon the information minister	REGRESSED
MTN South Sudan mobile operator licence	Licensed	Licensed	NO CHANGE
Regulator's power to order platform blocking	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	Exercised January 2025; no authorising instrument published	NO CHANGE
South Sudan International Gateway (SSIGW)	Operated by MGI Communications	Operated by MGI Communications, now under NCA oversight (2026-01)	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Gateway Services and Data Centre Oversight Committee	Did not exist	Constituted, with a mandate over gateway revenue digitisation and the national data centre (2026-01)	ADVANCED
National data centre, Juba	Reported as nearing completion (2025-09)	Reported as halfway complete (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines	None published (2025-08)	None published, unchanged from the November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target (2026-06)	NO CHANGE

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CREI solar-hybrid telecom energy programme	US\$5,000,000 committed (2024)	US\$10m committed in total; 490 of 499 MTN sites renovated and coverage reported to have risen from 69% to 80% of the population over three years (2026-02)	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Financial Services Security Lab	Did not exist	Operating; security-testing mobile payment applications (2026-03)	ADVANCED
National computer security incident response team	Not established (2025-08)	Not established, unchanged from the November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target (2026-06)	NO CHANGE

Both backbone programmes advanced on paper and neither delivered. The state route moved from a [US\\$9m design budget in June 2025](#) to a [2,400 km route announced in October 2025](#) with no construction date; the private route went from no licensed backbone operator to a [15-year licence effective 16 October 2025](#) and a [build in execution from early 2026](#).

The national data centre is the one row where the record moved backwards. It was [reported as nearing completion in September 2025](#) and [described as halfway complete in April 2026](#). Both are summit statements by or about the government and the two have not been reconciled, so no progress figure for the build can be stated for either date.

Institutional control tightened around infrastructure the state does not operate. The regulator [constituted an oversight committee with MGI Communications in January 2026](#) covering the international gateway and the data centre, both of which the same Swiss company holds at both ends of the period. Payment-security capacity was added through a [Digital Financial Services Security Lab with the ITU](#), and [spectrum strategy development was launched in July 2026](#) with nothing published.

Rural coverage is the one infrastructure row that stalled outright: in Kauto, [an extension expected from February 2026 was not delivered](#) and the area ended the period as it began it, with one site. Energy capacity did advance, privately: Finnfund's follow-on took its [total CREI investment to US\\$10m](#), with 490 of 499 MTN sites renovated.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Real-time gross settlement component	Did not exist	In use, with uptake reported but no figures published (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Identity and passport production machines	Did not exist	Five systems delivered (2026-05)	ADVANCED
National Identity Card issuance	17,400 cards issued to returnees and people at risk of statelessness through the EU and UNHCR project (2024-11)	Distribution running in Greater Yei; school-based registration for examination candidates launched in Juba, 4 August 2026, with expansion to more schools planned; no national coverage figure published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
New-generation passport and EAC passport	Did not exist	Announced intention with no legislative timetable; ordinary validity remains five years, and the immigration directorate has a route rather than a date - a memorandum submitted to the Inspector-General of Police, then the Minister of Interior, then the Council of Ministers, and finally the National Legislative Assembly, because the five-year limit is written into the law (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Passport issuance	Severe shortage across every passport category; issuance interrupted	Issuance running; the outgoing director of immigration and civil registry put stock at about 32,000 passport booklets and 172,000 national identity cards at the 9 August 2026 handover, alongside 100 new mobile registration kits, a Nairobi memorandum toward an integrated civil registration system, and adult passport validity extended to ten years. His successor says over a million people apply each year and that delays run to a month	ADVANCED
Unified national digital identity system	Did not exist	Announced as intent only; no law, budget, timetable, vendor or platform named (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Nationality Certificate (Jinsia)	Roughly 10% of the population holds one (2025-12)	Roughly 10% of the population holds one; no later coverage figure published	NO CHANGE
Displacement-tracking biometric registration	Not held	A large-scale biometric registration and re-registration exercise run by the migration agency across the Malakal protection-of-civilians site, the Bulakat transit centre and the Bentiu displacement camp, serving about 160,000 people between April and June 2026, with the community-feedback information desk used as the primary entry point for registration requests; feedback rose from a baseline of 1,998 to 23,986 pieces in the quarter, 56 per cent of it from women and girls and 17 per cent from vulnerable households, and no referral was recorded as completed or expired because the programming approach changed	BASELINE NOT HELD
Personal identity card (Butaka Shakhsia)	Not established	380,000 cards held by the directorate; required for banking, land and court (2026-01)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cash payment of tax at revenue offices	Cash accepted at revenue offices and by revenue officers	Barred; bank deposit and official slip required before a receipt is issued, while digital payment through Capital Pay continues (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Cashless payment for passports and identity documents	Cash accepted	Cash abolished; digital payment only (2026-01)	ADVANCED
National Instant Payment System (NIPS)	Roadmap announced, full rollout targeted for December 2025	No go-live documented; South Sudan absent from AfricaNenda's 2025 instant-payments census (2026-07)	STALLED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
South Sudan Interbank Payment and Settlement System (SSIPS)	Paper-based manual interbank process	Live: real-time gross settlement and automated clearing on ISO 20022, 13 banks at launch (2025-10)	ADVANCED
Mobile money as legal tender	In force	In force; no conduct supervision of the operator on record	NO CHANGE
Mobile money services (MTN MoMo, Digitel)	In service	In service; no agent, account or transaction figures published	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Centralised civil registration and vital statistics system	Civil Registry Rules and a costed CRVS plan adopted; a birth-registration pilot at Juba Teaching Hospital (2025-12)	Centralisation announced as intent; no law, budget, timetable, vendor or platform named (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Birth registration coverage	About 10% of births registered (2025-12)	About 90% of births going unrecorded (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Biometric registration of public servants	Not on record before January 2026	US\$15m programme in its third phase; data held on a Ministry of Finance server (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Education in Emergencies Management Information System	Did not exist	Launched; 12 County Education Departments across six states equipped with solar power, computers and connectivity (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic cargo tracking	Did not exist	In use, to curb diversion and smuggling (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Electronic visa portal	Not on record	In service; US\$50 for citizens of Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda and DR Congo and US\$100 for Somali, Burundian and Nigerian citizens (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Ensoft telecom revenue-assurance build-operate-transfer	Did not exist	Signed; the NCA hosts and oversees the system and it transfers to the state after six years (2025-10)	ADVANCED
NCA e-Services Platform	Did not exist	Launched (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Crawford Capital e-Government concession	In force, exclusive across trade permits, visas, tax, customs and work permits	In force; the contractor sanctioned by the United States in May 2026 and a ministerial review order overruled within 24 hours (2026-06)	NO CHANGE, CONTESTED

Identity gained documents and machines, not a system. Passport issuance moved from a severe shortage across every category to processing at about three days with stock stated to December 2026, five production machines were delivered in May 2026, and national identity card distribution reached Greater Yei in July 2026. Against that, birth registration stood at about 10% at both ends and Nationality Certificate coverage at roughly the same share of the population. Two systems that would change those numbers — a unified digital identity and a centralised civil register — moved from not existing to announced, with nothing named behind them.

The one biometric register that operates is a payroll. It went from [no record before January 2026 to a US\\$15m programme in its third phase](#), covering the organised forces, with data on a Ministry of Finance server and no data-protection authority over it at either end of the period.

Payments moved at the wholesale end only. [SSIPS entered service in October 2025](#), replacing a paper-based manual interbank process, and its [settlement component was reported in use by May 2026](#) without figures. The retail rail [stalled](#). Mobile money — the layer citizens actually transact on — was in force as legal tender at both ends, with [no conduct supervision on record at either](#).

Revenue systems accumulated. An [e-Services Platform](#), [electronic cargo tracking](#), an [e-visa portal with published fees](#) and a [six-year revenue-assurance agreement at 3.56% to the vendor](#) all entered the record where none stood before. The [e-Government concession they mostly run through did not move](#), though its position is now contested at both ends.

Technology

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
eSIM service	In service	In service; no take-up figures published	NO CHANGE

Nothing was built. What changed is external. [Huawei re-engaged after the post-2014 rift](#), moving from no engagement on record to interest expressed in the national data hub with no agreement or figure attached, and the [United States sanctioned the e-Government contractor in May 2026](#) without the concession ceasing to operate. The domestic sector was unchanged: [eSIM in service at both ends](#), with no take-up figures at either.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Innovation for Skills and Knowledge programme (Central Equatoria)	Did not exist	A costed plan; no financier, signed commitment or start date named (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Educational Technical Cooperation Project (China)	Committed across two phases	Committed across two phases; no later implementation record held	NO CHANGE
Mobile-money entrepreneur training programme	None published	1,225 graduates over a year, with business guidance and seed funding from the partner and digital financial-literacy training from the operator	BASELINE NOT HELD

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Internet users and penetration	1.3 million users, 12% penetration (2024)	1.9 million users, 15.7% penetration (2025)	ADVANCED
Mobile data price	About US\$23.70 per gigabyte (2025-11)	Raised twice by exchange-rate adjustment with no revised rate published (2026-07)	REGRESSED, REVISED RATES UNPUBLISHED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Operator tariff reduction	No reduction on record	A 25% cut applied, subsequently overtaken by two exchange-rate adjustments (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Use rose and affordability worsened. The regulator reported internet users moving from 1.3 million to 1.9 million and penetration from 12% to 15.7%, the only national measurement in the period. Against that, mobile data was about US\$23.70 per gigabyte in November 2025; MTN then cut tariffs by 25%, and two exchange-rate adjustments raised charges twice more with no revised rate published by anyone. The period therefore ends with no published price for mobile data.

Skills provision produced one costed plan and no delivery: Central Equatoria's three centres at a stated US\$2,806,100, with no financier or start date named.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Published national population estimate	13.2 million (2021)	About 16.36 million projected to end-2026 and 19.99 million to 2030 (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
United States sanctions on the e-Government contractor	Not sanctioned	Sanctioned; the concession continues to operate (2026-06)	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Huawei re-engagement	No engagement on record since 2014	Interest expressed in the national data hub and digital architecture; no agreement, contract or figure (2026-02)	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Satellite broadband licensing and market access	A satellite-broadband licence, authorisation register or NCA decision on market access.	not yet probed
Digital land register	A land-registry digitisation programme document, procurement or ministerial decision.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or geospatial data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate.	not yet probed
State or county digital service delivery	A state or county digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.	not yet probed
Comprehensive data-protection statute	The Data Protection Bill as introduced, or an enacted data-protection statute and the instrument constituting its commission.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal or policy	A national open-data portal, an open-data policy, or a public-sector information reuse instrument.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
European Union digital cooperation instrument	An EU-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, Global Gateway commitment or delegation programme document.	not yet probed
National artificial-intelligence strategy or programme	A national AI strategy, policy or programme document, or a ministerial decision establishing one.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with South Sudan	Any India-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document.	not yet probed
Gulf-state digital investment in South Sudan	A Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering South Sudanese digital infrastructure.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	The national budget or its annexes showing appropriation lines for the ICT ministry, the NCA or the Electronic Services Council.	2026-08-09
Public research programme in digital or data science	A public research programme, university research-centre mandate or published research output in digital or data science.	not yet probed

All twelve were unheld at both ends of the period, so none registers as movement. The two that matter most are the ones the period's own instruments should have produced: a data-protection statute, promised for 2026 alongside a cybercrime act that entered force, and a domestic budget line for the ministries and authorities carrying every programme above. Each was probed on 9 August 2026 and none returned a document.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.